NEW KID

Written by Ben Goddard

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Third Draft

FADE IN:

EXT. CITY PARK - DAY

A lush, tree-filled park in the middle of a shining metropolis. PUSH IN on a grassy area near a large pond. Some swing-sets, a bench where two women chat and smoke, and a LARGE SANDBOX.

C.J. (8, quiet, glasses too big for his face) plays in the sandbox by himself. He's got a well-worn SUPERMAN ACTION FIGURE.

He steers Superman, making his own sounds:

- Superman flies over the sandbox (whoosh!).
- Superman knocks over popsicle sticks in the sand (pow! pow!).
- Superman saves a marble, half buried in sand (help me!).

ZOOM IN on Superman as we

RIPPLE DISSOLVE TO:

EXT. DENSE JUNGLE (IMAGINATION) - SKY - DAY

We're now in C.J.'s imagination. The world and characters are plastic and toy-like. They MOSTLY move like real things, but constrained to their toy limitations. Everything is shiny, has mold seams, fingerprints, worn lacquer, chipped paint.

SUPERMAN (20s, spit-curl), ever-vigilant, soars miles above the thick canopy, scanning far and wide with his long-range vision.

SUPERMAN
(to himself)
I just know Lois is down there somewhere, trying to get photos of that mad doctor's plant experiments for her article for Perry. She really wants that--
(unsure)
Pew-el-itz-er. Pullit-zer.
(beat)
Award thing.

He flies on.

ON THE GROUND

LOIS LANE (20s, pretty), feisty reporter for The Daily Planet, moves amongst the lush plant life. She's dressed rather poorly for the jungle in her 1930's city reporter outfit.

Lois snaps photos of a lumbering ARMY OF TREE MONSTERS using her gigantic 1930's style camera. The tree monsters SPOT HER and begin to close in, but Lois stands her ground, unconcerned.

LOIS
These photos --
(Snap!)
-- will surely get me the --
(Snap!)
Pullit ... Pullitzer!

From out of nowhere, a tree monster SNATCHES HER UP, wrapping her in vines!

Lois finally realizes she might be in over her head.

LOIS
Ugh! Let go of me, you creepy carnivorous cryptid!

A WHOOSH and a THUMP as Superman lands nearby!

SUPERMAN
Trouble with the locals, Lois?

LOIS
(actually surprised)
Superman!

Superman PUNCHES the tree monster with the force of a freight train --

SUPERMAN
Pow!

-- shattering it to splinters! Lois drops safely to the ground, as Superman THROTTLES tree monsters left and right, each one exploding into jungle mulch.

SUPERMAN
Bam!

He BURNS a monster to ash with his HEAT VISION!

SUPERMAN
Heat vision!

He FREEZES another into a tree-scicle with his COLD BREATH!

SUPERMAN
Freeze breath!

He's totally loving this.

He turns to the last tree monster, a shocked look on its tree-face.

TREE MONSTER
I'm so sorry!

The tree monster throws his bark-covered limbs into the air and runs off, BAWLING.

Superman turns to Lois.

Smitten, Lois throws herself against Superman.

LOIS
Oh, Superman, how can I *ever* thank you?

She lifts her face to his and closes her eyes, lips puckered for a kiss.

SUPERMAN
Yuck, I don't kiss girls.

He pushes her away.

Out of nowhere, A GIANT SNEAKER stomps on them both!

We're rudely pulled out of the jungle and back to --

EXT. CITY PARK - SANDBOX - DAY

Attached to the normal-sized sneaker is MEANY (10, missing a tooth).

He holds up an, all-metal CONSTRUCTION TRUCK with big knobby tires and sharp edges. He raises his eyebrows: (Let's play my game instead).

C.J. looks at the sneaker that stepped on his imagination. The Superman toy is face down in the sand.

C.J. looks over his shoulder to --

EXT. CITY PARK - BENCHES - SAME

MOTHER (29, thin) sits, back to us, chatting animatedly with another mom. Both of them smoke cigarettes.

(Note: We only see adults from the neck down or back of the head.)

EXT. CITY PARK - SANDBOX - SAME

C.J. scoots back to make room --

-- and Meany SMASHES THE TRUCK into the sandbox and *goes to work*, rolling over the carefully placed set-pieces, and --

C.J. reaches for it, but it's too late --

-- the truck rolls over the Superman toy.

C.J. snatches his hand back, as Meany looks up, crazy eyes. We now see Meany has a black eye to go along with his missing tooth.

In the far distance, the soft RUMBLE of thunder.

EXT. DENSE JUNGLE (IMAGINATION) - DAY

Lois and Superman lie embedded face-first in the jungle floor.

Superman picks himself up, confused. What hit him? He helps Lois to her feet.

He cocks his head, hearing something.

The ENTIRE SURROUNDING JUNGLE SHAKES as a gigantic, unseen force approaches like the shockwave of an atomic bomb --

SUPERMAN
Lois! Look out!

A FAMILIAR-LOOKING ALL-METAL TRUCK THE SIZE OF A CITY BLOCK crushes the forest flat en-route to our heroes!

Superman can only THROW UP HIS ARM as the truck FLATTENS THEM BOTH INTO THE EARTH.

The truck stops, changes gears, then slowly backs up OVER HIM --

Beep. Beep. Beep.

A MEAN CONSTRUCTION WORKER (40s, black eye, missing a tooth) leans out the window. He grins, a fat stogy pinned between his teeth. No surprise, this is Meany aged up 30 years.

MEAN CONSTRUCTION WORKER
Ha ha, Superman sucks!

The truck spins out in the jungle vegetation, its tires BURNING RUBBER on helpless Superman's face!

MEAN CONSTRUCTION WORKER
Trucks KICK ASS!

Rolling to the side, Superman sits up, shocked at such foul language.

EXT. CITY PARK - SANDBOX - SAME

Meany LAUGHS as he repeatedly rolls his all-metal truck over the same spot in the sand, eyes wide with manic focus. C.J. snatches up his Superman toy, barely avoiding getting his fingers crushed.

EXT. CITY PARK - BENCHES - SAME

The two moms continue to chat and smoke, oblivious to the action. C.J. approaches, adjusting his glasses.

The wind picks up, scattering some leaves.

Mother keeps talking.

C.J. gently pulls on the fabric of her dress. Mother stops talking, drags her smoke, and checks her watch. She looks up at the gray sky, but then points to the swings.

C.J. looks across the grass at the boy on the swings: HUSKY (8, chubby, striped football jersey) sits on the swings by himself, picking his nose like it's a full-time job.

C.J. turns back to Mother --

Mother JABS a finger toward the swings.

Defeated, C.J. goes.

EXT. CITY PARK - SWING-SET - SAME

C.J. approaches the swing-set, Superman toy in hand.

Husky notices C.J.. He finishes his nose work and hops off the swings. He plucks up a real leather football and tosses it in the air: (Wanna play?)

C.J. nods relentingly and places Superman safely against the swing-set pole.

EXT. CITY PARK - GRASSY FIELD - SAME

With thick fingers, Husky tosses the football in a perfect spiral ... but C.J. reacts too late, and the football ricochets off his arm and goes spinning.

C.J. retrieves the football and lamely lobs it, end-over-end, in Husky's general direction, missing by a mile.

Husky scowls at C.J., hands on hips.

Husky glances to the Superman toy leaning against the swing-set, and a DIABOLICAL LOOK ripples across his face.

EXT. CITY PARK - POND EDGE - MOMENTS LATER

A majestic willow near the algae-covered pond's edge.

On tiptoes, C.J. balances Superman on a big, low branch, while Husky nods enthusiastically.

Husky backs away from the tree, football under his arm. C.J. follows him.

A gloomy cloud slides over the sun.

C.J. watches, impressed, as HUSKY spins the football on its pointy end on just one finger. Then, he looks to the Superman toy on the tree branch, concerned.

C.J. glances UP, as the sound of THUNDER overhead blurs with --

PRE-LAP: The ROAR of a hydro-electric dam.

EXT. HOOVER DAM (IMAGINATION) - NIGHT

The tippy-top of a massive hydro-electric dam. Water THUNDERS through the dam vents below.

Superman, bound chest-to-toe in GREEN KRYPTONITE CHAINS, teeters at the precipice of the dam!

The alien mastermind BRAINIAC (green skin, shiny metal suit) floats nearby in a purple spaceship. Lois struggles in the passenger seat, bound and gagged.

Brainiac's suit resembles Husky's football jersey.

SUPERMAN
(weak)
You'll ... never get away with this, Brainiac!

Brainiac grins a metallic smile. The diodes attached to his head flicker with red light.

Then, he digs into his "nose" with a long, metallic finger. Gross.

BRAINIAC
Just watch me, *Man of Tomorrow*!

Brainiac pulls a lever on the spaceship's control panel. A sinister robot arm extends from beneath the ship, clutching a single (vaguely football-shaped) ALIEN MISSILE.

Superman struggles fruitlessly in his Kryptonite chains.

LOIS
(muffled)
Mmm mmm, Mmmmmmm!

SUBTITLED: Look out, Superman!

Brainiac touches a GLOWING GREEN BUTTON.

The missile FIRES!

EXT. CITY PARK - POND EDGE

BONK! The spiraling football SLAMS into toy Superman and sends him catapulting through the air --

C.J.'S FACE

His expression: OH NO.

EXT. HOOVER DAM (IMAGINATION)

MUSIC CUE: *Ave Maria*

SUPER SLOW MOTION:

- A GIGANTIC GREEN FIREBALL, nearly frozen in time.

- From the center of the fireball twirls Superman, arse over teakettle, still bound in Kryptonite chains. A DAZED LOOK on his face.

- Brainiac LAUGHS MANIACALLY as his HEAD DIODES twinkle gleefully. Lois looks on, horrified.

END SUPER SLOW MOTION.

EXT. CITY PARK - POND EDGE

Close on the still, algae-covered pond water. A frog on a lily pad leaps away--

Toy Superman BLOOPS into the water, creating a Superman-shaped hole in the green pond scum, and immediately disappears.

C.J. rushes to the edge of the pond. His feet slide in the slimy mud, and he falls on his hands and knees in the gunk.

He looks at the small hole in the algae as it closes up. His toy friend is gone.

With a CRACK of thunder, THE CLOUDS OPEN. C.J. is instantly soaked. He doesn't stand up.

Husky grabs his football from the mud and BOUNCES IT once off C.J.'s head. C.J. doesn't move.

Husky shakes his head and runs off into the heavy rain.

The rain plasters C.J.'s hair to his face, only partially masking the tears running down his cheeks.

Mother runs up, picnic blanket over her head.

INT. STATION WAGON - MOMENTS LATER

A red traffic light.

Furiously swiping windshield wipers lose their battle against the storm. The heater BLOWS for all it is worth.

Mother glances at C.J., soaked to the bone, looking forlornly out the window through his fogged up glasses. She reaches out to touch his shoulder --

From behind: HONK!

The light green, Mother pops the clutch and they drive out of frame.

EXT. ELEMENTARY SCHOOL - MORNING

A hand-lettered sign in front of the school: WELCOME BACK!

Kids of all shapes and sizes mill about, a sea of new clothes and haircuts and backpacks and occasional headgear.

A bell RINGS.

INT. THIRD GRADE HOME ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

A pretty, red-haired teacher writes her name in big letters on the blackboard.

Settled in their seats, the kids go through the routine of passing stacks of paper from the front row to the back.

Very back row, far corner, C.J. sits quietly, doodling a small diamond-shaped "S" on the cover of a new notebook.

The kid in front turns to him.

C.J. looks up and meets the face of the NEW GIRL (8, friendly, freckles and headgear). A tight grin from her. A shy grin from him.

Her eyes flick to the back of his chair, where his coat with a SUPERMAN PATCH hangs.

She hands him the last paper in the stack and turns back around. The WHOOSH of her hair takes the paper from C.J.'s hands, and it see-saws ...

UNDER THE DESK

We hunker down under here as the paper wedges itself under New Girl's backpack. C.J. ducks down under to retrieve the paper.

He reaches for the pinned paper and notices a small PATCH on the backpack.

We lock onto it. It's shiny and cool. And yep, that's the gold -on-red WONDER WOMAN SYMBOL. He reaches to touch it--

And A FINGER taps his hand.

The finger is attached to the hand, attached to the arm, attached to -- the New Girl.

She gives him a thumbs up. He instinctively returns it ... then realizes she's JABBING UPWARD.

WIDE ON CLASSROOM

The teacher approaches the back corner of the room, a curious look on her face. The entire class watches.

The class: (He's in trouble...).

C.J. scrambles back into his seat just as the teacher gets to his desk, silently assessing the situation. He holds up the paper, embarrassed.

Beat.

She touches him gently on the shoulder and walks back to the front of the room.

New Girl risks a quick spin in her seat: (Whew!)

She suppresses a giggle.

C.J. manages a slow grin, his cheeks pink.

INT. SCHOOL BUS - DAY

C.J. sits alone, a few seats from the back. Kids chatter excitedly around him as the bus quickly fills up.

New Girl moves up the aisle, scanning for a seat. They're either full, or she's denied, row after row.

She stops at C.J.'s seat. He looks up. She raises her eyebrows.

He slides to the window. She plops down next to him, backpack in her lap.

Fully loaded, the bus trundles away from the school with a belch of exhaust.

New Girl hesitates, and then taps on C.J.'s SUPERMAN PATCH on his jacket. She nods at him, knowingly.

C.J. watches as she glances around, then unzips a SECRET COMPARTMENT on her backpack.

The bus turns a corner, and the sun catches her just right as --

She lifts a WONDER WOMAN ACTION FIGURE (with REAL ROPE LASSO) from the secret pocket. She hands it to him.

He takes it reverently. Turns it over in his hands. Instinctively, he SQUEEZES WONDER WOMAN'S LEGS together.

Wonder Woman punches double uppercuts! One-two, one-two.

He's in awe.

New Girl's eyes sparkle. (Isn't it cool?)

C.J. smiles, nods. (Heck yeah!)

We zoom out, through the open bus window, as the bus moves along through suburbia.

EXT. BACK YARD - DAY

A modest birthday party setup. Disposable tablecloth, paper plates, plastic jug o' purple juice. Hot dogs and hamburgers on a plate.

At the table, C.J. and New Girl. They're the only kids here. At the far end of the table, Mother smokes and chats with another mom.

New Girl wears two party hats like paper conical horns. C.J. laughs at her, and takes a big bite of his cheeseburger.

A WRAPPED GIFT is pushed toward him across the table. The paper is red with a gold bow.

C.J. puts down the burger, wipes his hands on his jeans, and picks it up.

The tag reads:

TO CLARK JAMES

And below that --

FROM DIANA

A tiny Wonder Woman symbol next to her name.

C.J. plucks the tag off and sticks it in his pocket. He tears into the wrapping paper.

DIANA (New Girl) watches, bouncing gently in her seat.

It's a brand new SUPERGIRL ACTION FIGURE. The look on his face is priceless.

He swallows.

He gingerly removes Supergirl from the package, slowly turning her over in his hands. He thumbs the REAL CLOTH cape. He holds Supergirl up to Diana and squeezes Supergirl's legs ...

Supergirl PUNCHES THE AIR, one-two, one-two.

Diana grins.

C.J. walks around the table and sits next to Diana.

Mother puts two pieces of cake in front of them.

C.J. politely takes a bite of cake. Diana picks up her entire slice and CRAMS IT INTO HER MOUTH!

She glances to him --

C.J. is WIDE EYED.

They both BURST INTO LAUGHTER. She sprays cake.

Pan down to their legs kicking the air together in childhood glee.

FADE OUT

EXT. HOOVER DAM (IMAGINATION) - DAY

We're back at the dam, though now we're in the middle of a wild thunderstorm. It's dark and pouring rain.

Far above the dam, SUPERGIRL (25, blonde), emerges from the dark storm clouds and begins a slow circle around the massive dam reservoir.

She scans the water far below. We may notice she has a SMALL WHITE DOT behind her ear.

SUPERGIRL
Can't see anything down there. Must be a high concentration of lead in that water.

A mostly-transparent SOMETHING pulls up alongside Supergirl. It's THE INVISIBLE PLANE, the pilot obscured by some combination of ancient magic and modern tech. (We can really only see the jet because it's where the rain isn't.)

PUSH IN as the pilot flips a switch, illuminating the cockpit with golden light.

Yep, it's WONDER WOMAN (eternally 30, gorgeous, ready for anything). She's also got a white dot behind her ear.

WONDER WOMAN
My scanners are also negative. They're likely affected by this strange energy storm.

SUPERGIRL
This could take a wh--

WONDER WOMAN
(no hesitation)
I'm going in.

Wonder Woman flips a lever, the plane's canopy slides aside, and she LEAPS into the air, arms across her chest as she plummets at great speed toward the water below --

EXT. CITY PARK - POND EDGE - DAY

Diana's red rubber boots SPLASH into the scum-covered water of the pond.

One of those gray, wet days where it's hard to tell what time it is, let alone the season. Mist drapes down from the foggy heavens, but does nothing to deter spirits.

C.J. and Diana (rain slickers and rubber boots) scrape the bottom of the pond with children's garden rakes.

ON A NEARBY, FAMILIAR TREE

Supergirl and Wonder Woman (action figures, both) face the pond. Water beads up on their plastic bodies. Supergirl's *real cloth cape* is damp.

BACK TO SCENE

Diana lifts her rake and checks it. Goop and sticks drain through the tines. C.J. searches the churning brown mucky water, looking a bit lost.

A SPLASH nearby. Diana and C.J. turn to see Meany at the edge of the pond. He's got no raincoat, just a dirty jacket ...

... and an armful of rocks.

Meany THROWS a rock at Diana, barely missing, but -- SPLOOP -- splattering her with pond water.

C.J. sees Meany and takes a step toward land--

--but the thick mud grips his boots, and he topples to his knees into the brown water.

He's soaked and filthy, glasses askew. We might notice that the wet hair on his forehead forms a spit-curl.

Meany BRAYS like a donkey, delighted. He throws a rock at C.J. this time, pegging him in the shoulder.

Diana's eyebrows furrow.

She angrily stomps through the pond water toward shore.

SUCK-SLURP. SUCK-SLURP.

Meany is so caught up in C.J.'s misfortune that he doesn't take notice of Diana until she is right next to him.

Side by side, she's smaller than him, but that doesn't matter in this moment; she's a furious, tiny, fireball.

Meany raises his arm to throw a stone at her, point blank --

-- but quick as lightning, she PUNCHES HIM IN THE NOSE.

Meany drops the stone and stumbles backward, clutching his nose.

C.J. watches on his knees, locked onto the scene, but then --

UNDER THE SURFACE

His hand finds a hard red plastic boot as it sticks up from the muck.

BACK TO SCENE

C.J. rises from the mucky water, pulling his Superman figure from the mud, a spark of joy in his eyes.

Diana's fists are bared as she kicks away Meany's last rock.

Still in shock, Meany's watering eyes glance at his hand: blood from his trickling nose.

C.J. tromps to shore and stands next to Diana. Diana looks at Meany and bares her teeth. He scrambles to his feet and stumbles away into the gray. They watch him go.

C.J. holds out Superman to Diana. Her face lights up. She gives C.J. a big, damp hug --

-- as the rain decides to really come down.

Soaked, they separate. C.J.'s cheeks are red. Perhaps his first hug in a long time.

Diana's hair is plastered to her face. She smiles at him despite the rain. He smiles back. Then, she sticks out her tongue at him.

He LAUGHS. She LAUGHS with him.

Diana take's C.J.'s hand and holds it out into the pouring rain.

ON SUPERMAN

The mud washes away, restoring Superman's bright colored superhero paint.

FADE OUT.

INT. MUD PORCH - NIGHT

Moonlight illuminates two pairs of muddy red boots on a mat, raincoats hung nearby. We move through the dark house, following the quiet sound of kids talking and giggling to the

LIVING ROOM

C.J. lays in a Wonder Woman sleeping bag, holding Superman and Supergirl in the air above him. Diana's in a Superman sleeping bag, holding Wonder Woman, cradling a flashlight in her armpit.

The flashlight hits our eyes and we're at --

EXT. HALL OF JUSTICE (IMAGINATION) - NIGHT

A peaceful evening with a full moon high in the sky. Supergirl and Superman sit side by side on the curved apex of the classic Hall of Justice building.

SUPERMAN
... luckily, I can hold my breath a *long* time.

Supergirl leans her head on Superman's shoulder.

SUPERGIRL
Seems like you were gone forever, cousin.

SUPERMAN
I missed you, too, Kara.

Superman cocks his head, hearing something.

They stand and turn.

Wonder Woman quickly approaches them from the rooftop.

SUPERGIRL
What is it, Diana?

WONDER WOMAN
Bizarro has torn open a hole to the fifth dimension over Hob's Bay.

SUPERGIRL
Ugh. That means--

ALL OF THEM
(unsure)
Mix-til-plik. Miss-tup-plix. Miz-tix-pleck.

Superman clears his throat.

SUPERMAN
That little floating guy.

SUPERGIRL
Yup.

WONDER WOMAN
Yes.

Wonder Woman closes her eyes and touches a finger to her tiara.

WONDER WOMAN
Follow me!

She SOMERSAULTS off the edge of the Hall of Justice, landing safely in the cockpit of her Invisible Plane.

Supergirl turns to Superman. She holds up her fist expectantly.

Catching her drift, Superman grins, and fist bumps her.

Wonder Woman pushes forward on the control stick and the Invisible Plane ROCKETS FORWARD into the night.

SUPERMAN
Up, up ...

SUPERGIRL
And away!

Together, they BLAST into the sky.

FADE TO BLACK.

THE END